

Here's How

By CHUCK WHITLOCK

Advice From Tucson

Once again the fiery-fingered juveniles of Tucson, whose eagerness with free advice and criticism of other people's business has kept readers in half laughter half sorrow befitting their half truths, have turned their narcissistic attention to University of Texas at El Paso.

This time the finger pointing is done by one Jan Petranek, with whom we are not familiar, of the Tucson Citizen. A word of caution at this point — the following piece was written and printed for the Tucson Citizen, despite the Phoenix date-line and the apparent preoccupation with Arizona State University.

We reproduce Petranek's column here, and take the liberty of interjecting comments along the way:

"The Case Against UTEP"

"Phoenix — This is a tale of two cities — El Paso and Phoenix.

"It also is a contrast between one of the finest collegiate baseball programs in the country and one of the sorriest.

"The principals of this story are Arizona State University and Texas-El Paso.

"The city of Phoenix, with a large assist from neighboring Tempe, treats ASU baseball like royalty. At ASU, as at Arizona, baseball is a showcase item. It is something to be proudly displayed, bringing national acclaim.

"At UTEP, it seems, baseball is an unwanted child. It is something to push into a corner and forget about. It is in its infancy and shows no signs of growing up.

"There is a clear comparison between ASU and UTEP.

(Ed. Note: Yep, ASU has had a fine baseball program for more than 20 years — UTEP for less than six. Arizona University for longer than both. ASU has a supply of state funds for its athletic program—So does Arizona U.—UTEP has nothing but what willing fans donate and what the fan-supplied athletic fund can budget. And this latter element grows each year.)

Nobody Saw Them Play

"Arizona made the expensive trip to El Paso two weeks ago and received one heck of a welcome — the same type of welcome the Tucson-Mexican Olympic Pavilion received.

"Nobody was there.

(Ed. Note: You'd think he would get some kind of message from that.)

"In fact there was a grand total of 40 spectators at Arizona's Friday game with UTEP (which didn't even out draw the players). The good people of El Paso saved face Saturday, however, as a fine crowd of 87 clamored into Dudley Field.

"I didn't even know there were that many people there, said one UA official, who could have counted heads easily enough.

And the clincher: There's no admission charge at UTEP.

(Ed. Note: You see, he came through the pass gate. Others do pay.)

"At the other extreme, 25,362 spectators paid their way into Phoenix Municipal Stadium last weekend to see ASU and UA conduct a three-game series. That figure includes a record-smashing 8,108 for Friday night's opener.

In General No Class

"UTEP's baseball program isn't first class. Or second class.

"It has almost no class.

"UTEP baseball is no credit to the growing Western Athletic Conference. Supposedly, baseball is big league in the WAC.

(Ed. Note: Supposedly by whom? Aside from the two Arizona schools, who specialize in it, who in the WAC has been heard of greatly in baseball in the past? And the fact that UTEP baseball is growing reflects well on the WAC program.)

"At UTEP baseball hardly exists.

"Perhaps the most dreadful part of UTEP baseball is Dudley Field. This monstrosity, also the home of El Paso's AA professional team, was in existence more than three decades ago when UA coach Frank Sancel played for the Tucson Cowboys.

(Ed. Note: So were the Empire State Building and the Arizona capitol.)

"Dudley Field makes Bear Down Gym look like the Taj Mahal. This miserable excuse for a baseball field must have the lowest mound in the country. The infield is a lost cause, but the outfield at least has grass.

(Ed. Note: Odd point here. If Dudley Field mound, certified by Texas League and NCAA, is 16 inches high in keeping with rules of organized baseball, how much are Arizona and other schools and all parks which have higher mounds violating that rule? As for comparing Dudley Field and Bear Down Gym, he's right . . . and we've seen Bear Down Gym.)

No Program, No Lunch

"While Dudley Field wallows in its shameful physical decay, there are other essentials missing.

"When Arizona played UTEP there were no programs. The food was atrocious (Luckily there was nobody there to eat it). And an assistant coach had to perform the job of public address announcer and official scorer.

(Ed. Note: These are essentials? First time we have heard of a program or a cold drink catching a fly or making a putout.)

"It was all quite unbelievable.

"Now, we come to UTEP baseball coach Andy Cohen.

"Cohen, who is really a good coach, is

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